

Petition for the Warding of Orin Veyra Before the Silent Choir

To the Silent Choir, whose judgment is kept behind the veil,

I, a petitioner of no consequence, place these words before your sealed hearing. Let them be weighed without favor, for sleep has become a gate through which hunger enters, and the waking world is not spared merely because the eyes are shut.

The danger named in this petition is the **Thorn Wraith**. It is a dream-feeder, drawing its nature from the invasion and consumption of dreams. It belongs as much to the terror of sleep as to the waking world. Those who speak of it describe a ghostly form threaded with thorn-like shapes, its outline cruel and insubstantial. It does not rage like a beast. It waits. It is intimate and predatory, haunting the mind with the patience of hunger. Such a thing need not break a door or spill blood before it has entered a household. A dream may be enough.

The person for whom I plead is **Orin Veyra**, whose recorded station is **Choir Novice** and whose recorded birth is **231 AS**. I do not claim knowledge of his private thoughts, nor do I accuse him of any offense. His temperament is unrecorded, and no physical details of him are recorded. Let no silence in the ledgers be mistaken for guilt. Yet precisely because he is young in service and because the Choir keeps what others cannot bear to name, I beg that his sleep be examined, guarded, and not dismissed as weakness or invention.

Should your judgment require a vessel of solemn keeping, let consideration be given to the **Diadem of Sorrowgate**. It is a reliquary forged in **281 AS**, bearing the name Diadem of Sorrowgate and carrying an atmosphere of sorrow and solemn possession. I know enough to state plainly that attunement to it costs **9**. Therefore let no hand be compelled toward it by panic, and let no novice be made to bear that cost without judgment. If it may ward the dream-feeder, use it only according to lawful discernment. If it may instead invite a deeper possession, lock it away and let its sorrow remain silent.

I ask neither vengeance nor spectacle. I ask a watched chamber, a guarded sleep, and a hearing before fear becomes testimony. If the Thorn Wraith has already touched Orin Veyra, find the wound. If it has not, do not make a wound by suspicion.

By ash, by silence, and by the mercy still unspent,

The petitioner's mark, pressed in black wax